

SOMETHING LESS THAN THE WHOLE

01x01 - PILOT

Written by

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OPEN ON:

EXT. PARK - NIGHT

QUIET.

Tree fronds are kindly swayed by the night breeze.

A SINGLE LOUD DRUM BEAT.

A YOUNG MAN RUSHES IN FRONT OF US.

TWO DRUM BEATS.

We PICK UP after the young man.

He runs in agony, constantly checking behind his shoulders.

DRUM ROLL IN FULL SWING.

The young man starts PANTING, worry increasing on his face by the second.

He looks behind his shoulders one more time.

MARK (O.C.)

JOSH!

Josh TRIPS AND FALLS in front of a bench.

DRUM HITS ONE LAST TIME.

Josh brings his face to the concrete, starts crying.

We hear footsteps slowly approaching.

Josh cries.

BLACK SHOES of a man enter the frame, right behind Josh's feet.

MARK (CONT'D)

Why, Josh? Why?

Josh erupts in a desperate cry.

The man in the black shoes sits at the right end of the bench as we transition to...

EXT. PARK - DAY

Josh is gone. The same black shoes at the same right end, at the left end a pair of WORN OUT sneaker at the end of grey sweatpants.

The man on the right is MARK (late 40's, handsome, rugged, posed), while the other is JEFF (early 40's, plain, bolding, relaxed). MARK is wearing a buttoned-up black shirt and black jeans with a belt that holds a voluminous silver buckle. JEFF is in gym clothes: grey sweatpants, stained grey sweater.

Between them is a BLACK LEATHER BRIEFCASE. Jeff keeps his left arm over it, as if to guard it.

They sit next to each other, but barely catch the other's eyes. They scan around as they converse, but we can't hear them yet.

JEFF

Do you think it still make sense?

Mark turns to him swiftly.

MARK

Are you having doubts?

JEFF

Aren't all of us?

MARK

I don't think we should be having this conversation.

JEFF

That's bullshit.

MARK

It doesn't matter.

JEFF

It does and it doesn't.

MARK

It doesn't.

Jeff rolls his eyes, before sticking them to the sky.

JEFF

What a shitty day, eh?

Mark pulls up his sleeve to check the time on his MASSIVE watch.

MARK

It's going to rain.

Without saying one more word, they both stand up and EXIT THE FRAME on the right, leaving the briefcase behind.

We stay on the bench for a FULL TIRTY SECONDS.

A couple strolls by, holding closed umbrellas. A dog retrieves a stick far behind the bench.

Then the sky rumbles and, as Mark predicted, it starts to rain. Copious rain.

As the second approach their end, a MAN IN A BLACK SUIT, wearing a FEDORA HAT, enters the frame on the same side Mark and Jeff exited from. He is unbothered by the rain, unbothered by anything.

Without interrupting his stride, without ever revealing his face to the CAMERA, he picks up the briefcase and rapidly exits on the other side.

The sky rumbles again, almost growling, as we go to...

OPENING CREDITS: SOMETHING LESS THAN THE WHOLE

EXT. CHESTERFIELD HIGH - DAY (ESTABLISHING)

It is still raining, although it's less intense. Puddles have begun to form. The surroundings are quiet: school is in session.

INT. GYM - CHESTERFIELD HIGH - CONTINUOUS

All the high school students are gathered on the stands. PRINCIPAL LAWLER (60's, tall, energetic) is giving a speech with the rest of the teaching staff standing firmly behind him.

On the extreme left, almost in a corner, almost hiding, still wet, we see JEFF.

PRINCIPAL LAWLER

The recent events have left an undeniable and incomparable stain on the fine fabric of our community. That is because those events have affected - and transpired from - the very core of our community. YOU.

(a beat)

You are the beating heart of our fine town of Chesterfield. It only takes one skip of a beat, one seemingly irrelevant hiccup in the natural course of events, to bring it all to a halt. We cannot allow that to happen.

(MORE)

PRINCIPAL LAWLER (CONT'D)
We will not allow that to happen.
And neither will you.

He scans around the audience, seemingly pouring his concentrated stare on every single one of those ingenuous kids.

PRINCIPAL LAWLER (CONT'D)
So - wrapping this up so you can
get back to your classes - never -
I repeat - *NEVER* forget what
happened, and at the same time
always - *ALWAYS* - remember our
motto. Our way.

He gestures to the students to stand up, then looks back at the teacher as if to make sure they would follow.

LAWLER, TEACHERS, STUDENTS
MOVE FORWARD! ALWAYS MOVE FORWARD!

The bell rings.

INT. CLASSROOM - CHESTERFIELD HIGH - LATER

The teacher is scribbling some math equation on the blackboard, while most of the students seem to be more bemused with the rain drops hitting the old windows.

All the way at the back of the class, two students, TARA (17, dark hair, cheerful) and CHRISTOPHER (CHRIS, 17, short blonde hair, conceited) are deep in a whispered conversation.

CHRIS
So you are not gonna go?

TARA
No.

CHRIS
No what?

TARA
I'm not gonna go.

CHRIS
Why wouldn't you go?

TARA
We are technically still not
allowed to go out at night.

CHRIS
Why are you doing this to me?

TARA
I'm not doing this to you. It's a
just a stupid party - go by
yourself.

CHRIS
(raising his voice a
little)
I can't go by myself.

Tara notices people around are starting to eye at them.

TARA
Lower your fucking voice.

CHRIS
(lower again)
I said - I can't go by myself, she
invited you, not me.

TARA
Oh, did she?

CHRIS
Yeah.

TARA
That's weird, I thought she would
for sure invite the weird guy that
always stares at her.

CHRIS
I don't *always* stare at her.

TARA
I don't give a shit.
(raising her hand)
MRS. KELLY?!

MRS. KELLY (50's, comforting) stops writing and turns to
Tara.

MRS. KELLY
Yes?

TARA
Is it okay if I go to the toilet
real quick?

MRS. KELLY
As long as it is real quick.

TARA
Of course, Mrs. Kelly.

Mrs. Kelly goes back to her math and Tara stands up to exit the room.

As she leaves, Chris stares at her disappointed. Tara reaches the door and, while opening it, cheekily gives the finger to Chris who...

CHRIS
(mouthed)
Fuck you.

INT. INLAND CAFÈ - DAY

MONICA (40's, blonde) is cleaning up the counter. The café is almost empty, there's only an old man sitting all the way in the back, working a crossword in a newspaper.

MARK walks in and dries his shoes on the mat. Monica welcomes him in with a warm smile.

MONICA
Hello Mark.

MARK
(going to sit at the
counter)
How are you, Mon'?

MONICA
Everything good. Slow day.

MARK
Yeah, people are still a little
wary I guess - this rain sure
doesn't help.

MONICA
Yeah, I guess so.

She glimpses at the empty tables, a touch of concern sparks in her eyes. Mark catches it.

MARK
It's going to be fine. Really.

MONICA
Coffee? Black?

MARK
Is there any other way?

Monica excuses herself to go grab the pot. Mark turns around to see the old man looking at him. Mark waves.

MARK (CONT'D)
Good morning.

The old man shakes his head and goes back to its paper.

Monica comes back and fills Mark's mug with some steaming hot coffee.

MARK (CONT'D)
Thank you very much.

MONICA
Of course.

MARK
What's the deal with...

He nods towards the old man.

MONICA
That's just Edgar. He's a grumpy
old man.
(to Edgar)
Aren't you Ed?

Edgar mumbles something indecipherable, without taking his eyes away from the game.

MONICA (CONT'D)
How have you never met him before?

MARK
That's a very good question.

Mark takes the first sip out of his mug,

MARK (CONT'D)
Can I ask you something, Mon?

MONICA
Sure, go ahead.

MARK
How's Chris been doing? Is he okay
now? You know I worry about the
kid.

MONICA
That's very nice of you. He seems
okay. I think. I don't know.
(MORE)

MONICA (CONT'D)

Kind of hard to tell how your son is really doing when he doesn't really talk to you.

MARK

I think it's normal, we've all been seventeen. You know how kids are.

MONICA

Well, that's what I keep hearing, but I don't think I was ever that way. Not that much at least.

MARK

Times change, I guess.

MONICA

They really do.

Mark takes a sip.

MARK

It's really wonder-

MONICA

Thank you for talking to him.

Mark is sort of taken aback.

MARK

Are you kidding? Of course. It's the least I could do.

MONICA

It's just - he doesn't like to show it, but he's sensitive, you know? He feels for other people. He always has. I think that's why this all thing weighted so much on him.

MARK

Monica, I promise you, you don't have to thank me. He's a good kid. We all loose are grip some times.

Monica shakes her head, smiling.

MONICA

You are right. I'm sorry. I guess I'm a little sensitive myself.

Mark smiles back at her, tenderly, and as he does a couple enters the café. They leave their umbrellas in the stand.

MAN #1
(to Monica, pointing at a
table)
Can we sit there?

MONICA
(to the man)
Of course, as you please.
(to Mark)
Excuse me.

MARK
Oh no, please.

Monica grabs two nearby plastic menus and goes around the counter to bring them to the couple.

Mark slyly lifts up his sleeve and checks his watch. It's almost eleven. He quickly covers it back, before taking one more, large sip of Joe.

Monica comes back and Mark downs the last bit of his coffee.

MARK (CONT'D)
I gotta run.

MONICA
Sure.

Mark takes out his wallet and leaves a bill on the counter. Then, after a quick consideration, he takes out another one, but before he can put it over the other...

MONICA (CONT'D)
Don't.

MARK
Monica.

MONICA
Put it away. This is not a charity.

Mark it's disappointed, but gets it.

MARK
I'm just trying to help.

MONICA
I know.

MARK
I'll see you later, okay?

MONICA

Yeah.

Mark leaves the café. Monica keeps her eyes on him as he walks away, there's some history there. Once he's out of her sight she turn to the couple.

MONICA (CONT'D)

Ready to order?

I/E. MARK'S CAR/STREET - MOMENTS LATER

Mark is driving down the road in his black FORD VICTORIA, it has known better days, but it still does the job wonderfully.

As he strides down Chesterfield Boulevard, the town's main artery, he peeks at the closed down shutters, the empty tables outside of cafés and bars, the few, courageous passersby.

He reaches a red light and shuts off his windshield wipers. It has stopped raining. He leans over to look up at the sky, there's no light up there.

Mark waits a little for the traffic light, red for nobody to cross, to switch to green. As soon as it does, he bolts away.

EXT. VIRGIN MARY HOSPITAL - DAY (ESTABLISHING)

It's a small hospital, Chesterfield is not a large town after all.

A sign on the front lawn recites "**OMNIBUS CURANTIS**"

Mark enters the frame and walks up the stairs towards the entrance.

INT. HALL - VIRGIN MARY HOSPITAL - CONTINUOUS

The hall is not pleasant. The walls are moldy. There are about fifteen grey plastic seats and two almost empty vending machines next to reception, where RACHEL (20's) is sitting behind the counter.

Mark approaches. As he gets closer we see there's no computer on her desk, only a landline phone.

Rachel is scribbling something on a piece of paper when Marks gets to her.

MARK

Hi.

RACHEL
Hello. How can I help you?

MARK
I'm here to see Dr. Rosenthal? We
had an 11.15.

RACHEL
Sure, let me just check.

Rachel picks up a thick folder with alphabetically ordered
labels from under her desk and opens it on the letter R.

She run her index down the page then stops.

RACHEL (CONT'D)
Mark Reece, right?

MARK
Yeah, that's me.

RACHEL
(gesturing towards the
elevator)
She's waiting for you downstairs.

MARK
Thank you.

She nods smiling. Marks proceeds towards the elevator.

INT. ELEVATOR - CONTINUOUS

Mark enters the elevator and presses the button under 0. M.
Morgue.

The light in the elevator is of an unhealthy yellow and it
flickers as Mark slowly descends under the hosipital.

It goes down, 1, 0 then DING, M. Mark exits.

INT. CORRIDOR - VIRGIN MARY HOSPITAL - CONTINUOUS

The elevator opens on the corridor towards the main chamber.
It's cold and unpleasant. Just grey walls under neon lights,
leading towards a metal door that is right now opened.

Mark heads towards the chamber without hesitation. He knows
the place.

INT. MORGUE - VIRGIN MARY HOSPITAL - CONTINUOUS

Marks walk in to find DR. HELEN ROSENTHAL (50's, grey hair, short, cold) looking over a CORPSE (male, 30's) positioned on the metal table.

MARK
How's he doing?

ROSENTHAL
(without turning to him)
I see you finally dared to show up.

MARK
I'm fifteen minutes late.

ROSENTHAL
You are late.
(gesturing)
Come here.

Mark walks over to the other side of the table.

MARK
What do you say?

ROSENTHAL
Whatever you want me to say and
then I throw him down to the
furnace.

MARK
Why do you have to be so crude all
the time, Jesus.

ROSENTHAL
Because I'm old and I'm tired and-

She rotates the head of the corpse towards Mark revealing a
HUGE LACERATION on his right temple.

ROSENTHAL (CONT'D)
What the fuck is this?

MARK
A mistake. I didn't know.

ROSENTHAL
Don't lie to me.

MARK
I'm not.

ROSENTHAL
Whatever.

She throws a blanket over the body to cover it all and leans with her elbows on the table. Positioning her joints mere centimeters away from the dead.

ROSENTHAL (CONT'D)
I think it's gonna be okay. It was handled fast and it was handled silently.

MARK
Good. That's good.
(a beat)
Do you have to lean on him like that?

ROSENTHAL
What difference does it make?

MARK
That's a person.

ROSENTHAL
Is it now? Do you think I'm not aware that this corpse with a five inch blunt force trauma laceration on his right temple was, indeed, a person?

MARK
That's not what I'm saying.

ROSENTHAL
Then what are you saying?

MARK
Doesn't matter.

She shakes her head and rises from the table.

ROSENTHAL
Smoke?

MARK
I don't smoke.

ROSENTHAL
You never know.

Rosenthal turns to the nearby chair and takes out a pack of cigarettes and a lighter. She takes one out and throws the pack over the body.

ROSENTHAL (CONT'D)
How long have we known each other?

MARK
I don't know. Twenty? Twenty-five years?

ROSENTHAL
It's twenty-seven.

She lights the cigarette.

ROSENTHAL (CONT'D)
Do you think I give a shit? About all of this?

MARK
I know you do.

ROSENTHAL
Then stop acting all Mr. Mysterious Righteous and tell me what the hell is going on.

MARK
I met up with Jeff this morning.

ROSENTHAL
How'd it go?

MARK
Fine. It's not the point. He said people are having doubts.

ROSENTHAL
Of course they are. The kid was seventeen. This man right here -

She ashes her cigarette on the blanket.

ROSENTHAL (CONT'D)
He was thirty-two. He didn't even do anything wrong, he was just nobody. He just fitted a profile. He was a mean to an end he didn't even know existed.

MARK
We don't get to pick and choose.

ROSENTHAL
Shouldn't we though?

MARK
I don't think so.

ROSENTHAL
Me neither.

She goes to put the cigarette out on the blanket, but-

MARK
Don't.

ROSENTHAL
It's a fine line, Mark. It can be
cruelty, it can be justice, it can
be-
(throws the cigarette to
the ground)
-bad luck, it all depends on how
you frame it.

MARK
What should I do?

ROSENTHAL
Wait it out. Trust me, it's gonna
go away. It always does.

MARK
What if it doesn't?

ROSENTHAL
Well - then we are fucked.

Mark checks his watch, this time without subtlety.

MARK
I have to go.

ROSENTHAL
I know.

As Mark exits the room and heads for the elevator,
Rosenthal...

ROSENTHAL (CONT'D)
I almost forgot! The sister! I
heard she hasn't left yet.

Mark doesn't flinch at the remark and continues towards the
elevator.

EXT. STREET - DAY

School's over. Tara and Chris are on their bikes in the middle of the street in a residential area of Chesterfield.

TARA
I can't believe they are are still
going to hold The Games.

CHRIS
Why wouldn't they?

TARA
It's a bit soon. Don't you think?

CHRIS
I don't know. We do have to move
forward.

TARA
My God. I hate it when you talk
like that.

CHRIS
Like what?

TARA
Forget it.

GUY #1
Yo! Chris! Tara!

They turn around to see a friend of theirs, JAMES (17, tall, dark hair), sprinting on his bike. They slow down so that he can catch up. James comes up on Chris' left side.

CHRIS
What up James?

JAMES
Everything good. How 'bout you
guys?

CHRIS
It's okay.

TARA
Hi James.

JAMES
Hi Tara.

James looks around.

JAMES (CONT'D)
Where are you guys going this way?

CHRIS
Work.

JAMES
Really?

CHRIS
Yeah.

TARA
Why?

JAMES
What time do you get off?

TARA
Eightish. Maybe something later.

JAMES
What? Are you guys not coming?

CHRIS
Where?

JAMES
Do you not know?
(to Tara)
How does he not know?

TARA
He knows.

CHRIS
How do you know?

JAMES
Danny told me.

CHRIS
How does Danny know?

JAMES
I don't know.

TARA
How many fucking people did Leah
invite?

JAMES
Yeah right? It's gonna be great.

TARA
I'm not going.

JAMES
You are kidding.

TARA
I'm not.

JAMES
(to Chris)
Bro. Are you hearing this?

CHRIS
Been hearing it all morning.

JAMES
But you are coming, right?

CHRIS
I don't know.

JAMES
What do you mean you don't know?
Are you guys scared we are gonna
get in trouble? The place is all
the way up in Gage. There's nobody
up there.

CHRIS, TARA
That's not point.

JAMES
Jesus.

TARA
I'm just not going.
(to Chris)
But you should totally go if you
want to.

CHRIS
I'm a plus one, not a guest. I
can't show up as a plus one without
the main one.

TARA
You do know it's not a wedding
right?

CHRIS
(mocking)
You do know it's not a wedding?
(MORE)

CHRIS (CONT'D)
(normal)
I know, Sherlock.

TARA
That doesn't even make sense.

CHRIS
(mocking)
That doesn't even make sense.

TARA
Are you twelve?

The three of them approach a crossroads.

JAMES
I'm going left here.

CHRIS
Right for us.

JAMES
Yeah.
(a beat)
I'll see you later guys, okay?

CHRIS
Yeah.

TARA
See you.

James turns left, the guys proceed to the right.

TARA (CONT'D)
You are embarrassing.

CHRIS
You are annoying.

INT. INLAND CAFÈ - LATER - DARK

Tara and Chris are now behind the counter. They work there. The place has gained a little life. There's a group of three old ladies having tea at a round table, a couple of guys in leather jackets enjoying a beer at the counter and a young man reading a book on his own at a table outside.

Although there is some clientele, we can assume they are pretty much regular customers, as Tara and Chris don't seem to be very much concerned with professionalism.

To the contrary, Chris is holding a bucket of ice on one end of the counter, while Tara is preparing her shot on the opposite extremity.

TARA

Three seconds on the clock. They need a three to win it. Horne comes out of the pick-n-roll. The dribble. She shoots.

The ice cube Tara was holding arches in the air over the counter before falling right on Chris' forehead. The ice bounces off of it, before ending right down the bucket.

CHRIS

She did it again! She did it again! Chesterfield High is champion for the one-hundred-millionth time.

Tara takes a couple of bows to the surrounding imaginary audience.

TARA

Thank you. Thank you.

GUY IN LEATHER JACKET

That was actually nice.

TARA

(pointing at him)

And thank you.

The guy smiles, before him and his friend empty their bottles, leave some cash on the counter and leave.

Tara collects the bills and the bottles, while Chris places the bucket back in the fridge.

CHRIS

What time is it?

Tara checks the clock in front of them.

TARA

Forty-five.

CHRIS

That went fast.

TARA

Yeah.

(a beat)

I'm gonna tell the guy outside we are going to close in a bit.

CHRIS
You should get your jacket.

TARA
It's fine. It's gonna take a second.

Tara goes around the counter to exit.

CHRIS
(to the old ladies'
table, as Tara exits)
We are going to close in fifteen minutes girls.

OLD LADY #1
WHAT?!

CHRIS
WE ARE CLOSING IN FITEEN MINUTES
GLADYS.

GLADYS
(to an other lady)
He always mumbles, I can never hear what he says.

EXT. INLAND CAFÈ - CONTINUOUS

Tara exits the café and approaches the guy reading outside. There's nothing on the book. It's just blue.

TARA
Hi.

The guy puts down the book and looks up at Tara. He looks older than her, while still young. He looks shy. His name is LEWIS.

LEWIS
Hi.

TARA
We are closing in fifteen.

LEWIS
That's alright. Thanks for letting me know.

TARA
Aren't you a little cold out here?

LEWIS
I don't know. I hadn't noticed.

TARA
Are you from around here?

LEWIS
Kind of. Yeah. What's your name?

TARA
Tara.

He extend his hand.

LEWIS
I'm Lewis. Nice to meet you, Tara.

Tara extends her hand back and they shake on it.

TARA
Nice too meet you, Lewis.

WE QUICKLY CUT TO CHRIS AT THE OLD LADIES' TABLE AS HE
WATCHES TARA AND LEWIS BUT CAN'T HEAR THEM.

GLADYS
Do we need to leave now?

CHRIS
Huh? What?

GLADYS
Do we need to leave now, young man?

CHRIS
Yes.

GLADYS
That's rude.

CHRIS
I know.

WE GO BACK TO TARA AND LEWIS AS THEY LAUGH.

LEWIS
I'll make sure to stop by again
then.

TARA
That would be nice.

LEWIS
Yeah, I should go now.

He picks up his book.

TARA
What are you reading there?

LEWIS
The Portrait of Dorian Gray. It's
an old book.

TARA
I don't think I have ever heard of
it.

LEWIS
That's too bad.

As the old ladies walk out of the café, Lewis excuses
himself.

LEWIS (CONT'D)
It was nice meeting you, Tara.

TARA
See you soon.

Lewis leaves.

TARA (CONT'D)
(as she re-enters, to the
old ladies)
Have a good evening ladies.

INT. INLAND CAFÈ - CONTINUOUS

As Tara comes back in, Lewis waits for her sitting on one of
the tables. He just stares at her, monotone.

TARA
What?

Chris smirks.

CHRIS
Nothing.
(a beat)
Can we just clean up and get the
hell out of here?

TARA
Yeah. Sure.

CHRIS
Great.

Chris heads for the storage closet in the back, while Tara just looks at him, a bit perplexed, a bit satisfied, maybe.

EXT. PARKING LOT - NIGHT

It's the large parking lot of Chesterfield's shopping mall. It's completely empty, if not for Mark's car. A blue car enters the frame and several rows behind Marks car.

Jeff exits the blue car. He's wearing blue jeans, a nice white polo and what he would believe to be a cool navy jacket. He has what left of his hair slicked back.

He walks towards Mark's car and enters on the passenger's sit.

The car drives away as soon as the door has been closed.

INT. MARK'S CAR - CONTINUOUS

Mark is dressed exactly the same way we've been seeing him dressed so far.

MARK

I went to see Rosenthal today.

JEFF

Yeah?

MARK

Yeah.

JEFF

What'd the old nag have to say?

MARK

What do you think Dr. Rosenthal had to say?

JEFF

I don't own a crystal ball yet, Mark.

MARK

The guy was open on his temple like he was hit with a fucking hammer.

JEFF

It was a bat.

Mark stops the car, immediately.

QUICK SHOT OF THE SURROUNDING AREA: ISOLATED ROAD BETWEEN SOME FIELDS, NO OTHER CARS IN SIGHT.

MARK

You think it's funny?

JEFF

Kind of. Yeah.

MARK

What the fuck is wrong with you? It could all go up in smoke-

Mark snaps his fingers.

MARK (CONT'D)

Like this.

JEFF

Who the fuck put you in charge of moral and ethics? Like, seriously, do you ever hear yourself talking? All this righteousness. You know we call you righteous Mark, behind your back, right? You think it's because we respect you? You think it's because we are in awe of how great your moral compass is? We make fun of you, Mark, and we pity you. I smashed the guy's head in, yes, so what, Mark? So what? You were the one that pulled the trigger on a seventeen-year-old. You. Did you stop for a second to consider whether that was right? Whether it made sense? Of course you didn't. You did as you were told, as we all do. We are all the same. You are no better than anybody else. You are probably worse. Because admit you're just as fucked up in the head.

MARK

Are you done?

JEFF

Yes.

Mark starts the car again and they proceed along the road, in silence.

EXT. THE GAS STATION - LATER

It used to be a gas station, but it has been turned into a bar. It's not the most lively night, but a small crowd is still outside the doors, while rock music plays inside.

Mark's car pulls up and parks in a spot on the far right.

INT. MARK'S CAR - CONTINUOUS

Jeff is checking his teeth in the rearview mirror.

JEFF

What does she look like?

MARK

She's twenty-six, blonde, tall.

JEFF

Kinda like the brother.

MARK

Yeah.

JEFF

You sure she doesn't know me?

MARK

Why would she know you?

JEFF

I'm the gym teacher.

MARK

It's not like you are the mayor.

JEFF

Jesus. Remember the mayor? That was such a big deal.

MARK

Yeah.

(a beat)

We ready?

Jeff runs his hand through his hair.

JEFF

Let's go.

They exit the car.

EXT. THE GAS STATION - CONTINUOUS

As Mark and Jeff head towards the bar entrance.

INT. CHRIS' ROOM - NIGHT

Chris's room is your average seventeen-year-old room. It's messy, clothes are scattered, the bed on which he's laying his undone. Chris is reading a sport magazine in his pyjama when something hits his window.

He puts down his magazine and looks around confused, but when nothing follows, he goes back to reading.

After a couple of seconds, the thumping sound is heard again.

He stands up and goes to the window to find TARA underneath it, with her bike by her side.

Chris opens up the window.

CHRIS
What the hell are you doing here?!

TARA
We are going. Come down.

CHRIS
What? Really?

TARA
Hurry up before I change my mind.

CHRIS
Jesus. Alright.

Chris closes back the window. A big smile appears on his face, then fades as he starts to throw clothes around in search for something to wear.

Finally, he finds a white t-shirt, a pair of baggy jeans and a purple sweater. He quickly checks himself out in his mirror, he likes the fit, yet something is clearly bothering him.

He throws his black puffer jacket on and he is ready to SNEAK OUT the window, when he ears a KNOCK on his door.

CHRIS (CONT'D)
Yes?

MONICA (O.C.)
Hey sweetie, can I come in real
quick? I need to ask you something.

Chris freezes. He looks down the window, where Tara is
worryingly looking all around. Making sure no one is coming.

MONICA (O.C.) (CONT'D)
Chrissy?

CHRIS
Ehm... Yeah sure. Just a second.

Chris gets out of his jacket and launches it onto the bed.

CHRIS (CONT'D)
Come in.

Monica enters through the door. She's in her pyjama, wearing
thick glasses. She looks tired.

MONICA
Hey listen -

She pauses and scans the room. Immediately noticing her
son's outfit and the jacket on the bed.

MONICA (CONT'D)
Are you going somewhere?

CHRIS
No? Of course not.

MONICA
Why are you all dressed up then?

CHRIS
I was just... I was just trying on
some clothes for tomorrow.

MONICA
What's tomorrow?

CHRIS
School?

MONICA
Since when do you try on clothes
for school the day before?

CHRIS
Well, since it's the only time I'm
allowed to go out, I might as well
try to look nice. Don't you think?

MONICA

For starters, you would look nicer if you weren't picking out clothes out of a pile on the floor. It's a mess in here, Chrissy. You are not a kid anymore, you should take better care of the space-

CHRIS

Did you come in just to criticize me? Like. You could have just written me a letter with your list of complaints if that was it.

MONICA

Come on, Chrissy. You know what I mean.

CHRIS

I don't. I never do. What did you want to ask me?

Monica shakes her head.

MONICA

Whatever.

(a beat)

Do you know if The Games are still happening?

CHRIS

Why?

MONICA

Are they?

CHRIS

Tara asked me the same thing. Of course they are happening.

MONICA

Oh! That's good.

CHRIS

Why are you asking, mom?

MONICA

Well - it's just an idea - but I thought we might help with the catering, you know? With the café. Since we would be closed anyways.

CHRIS

I guess that makes sense?

MONICA
Right?

CHRIS
I don't know, ma'. Whatever you
want.

MONICA
Okay. I'm gonna talk to Coach Jeff
tomorrow, run the idea by him.

CHRIS
Sure.

A beatt of awkward silence falls over the room.

MONICA
Well. I'm gonna leave you to it,
then.

CHRIS
Thanks.

MONICA
(as she exits)
I love you, Chrissy.

CHRIS
Love you too, ma'

Monica smiles satisfied and exits the room.

Chris waits for his mother's steps to signal she's back
downstairs, then climbs out the window.

EXT. CHRIS' HOUSE - MOMENTS LATER

As Chris slides down the gutter pipe.

TARA
What took you so long?

CHRIS
Shut up.

Chris looks at Tara a bit weirdly. Almost resentful.

TARA
What?

CHRIS
Nothing.

EXT. STREET - LATER

Tara and Chris are on their bikes in a somewhat secluded street. It's not well-lit. It looks like people used to live there and now they don't anymore. They bike in silence.

TARA

What's wrong with you?

CHRIS

Why are we going?

TARA

You are the one that pressed me all day to go.

CHRIS

And you didn't want to.

TARA

So what? I changed my mind. Am I not allowed to change my mind?

CHRIS

Sure. You changed your mind.

TARA

What are you even talking about?

CHRIS

That guy is going to be there, isn't he?

TARA

What guy?

CHRIS

Oh come on. You know who I'm talking about. The one you were flirting with outside of the café.

Tara abruptly stops her bike. Chris follows.

CHRIS (CONT'D)

What?

TARA

What the fuck is your problem?

CHRIS

My problem? I don't have any problem. You can just say we are going because you want to see this guy. It's fine. I don't care.

TARA

Oh you don't care. Sure. But let me get this straight. We are not going because I want to see Lewis. We are going because I got into a stupid fight with my parents and I just couldn't bare it to be there any longer. Not that you would give a shit about it. Second of all, I wasn't flirting with anybody, but even if I was, where do you get off acting like this? God forbid someone treats me nicely for a change. Right?

Chris realizes he fucked up.

CHRIS

I'm sorry.

TARA

Sure.

CHRIS

What happened with your parents?

TARA

A bit late, isn't it?

Tara jumps on her bike and sprints ahead.

CHRIS

Tara.

TARA

Fuck off, Chris. I'll see you there. You know the way.

INT. THE GAS STATION - SAME TIME

The bar is not crowded, but it's not empty either. A band, led by a BEAUTIFUL SINGER (think Mädchen Amick beautiful), is accompanying the night with some soft, ambience, melancholic rock.

Mark and Jeff sit at a corner booth, but they don't look at each other, they let their beers sit, as their focus is on a YOUNG WOMAN sitting at the counter by herself.

JEFF

What did you say her name was?

MARK

I didn't. But it's Deandra.

JEFF
Goes by Dee?

MARK
I guess. I don't know.

JEFF
Okay. Got it.

Jeff picks up his beer and chugs it all in one sip.

JEFF (CONT'D)
Game time.

Jeff stands up and after a couple of steps turns back to Mark.

JEFF (CONT'D)
Try not to look too creepy in that corner, okay?

MARK
What do you mean creepy?

JEFF
What do I mean- Jesus, Mark. Just-
Whatever. I don't care.

Mark looks at his clothes, not sold on Jeff's remark.

We stay on Jeff as he swiftly takes a sit at the counter next to DEE. Her profile fits the description Mark gave in the car. She is the sister of the corpse Mark went to examine in the morning.

Jeff peeps at Dee. Her eyes are puffy and lost the bottom of her orange drink.

JEFF (CONT'D)
(to bartender)
Can I get a Screwdriver?

Dee turns her head to Jeff, he smiles at her as if he were a completely different character.

BACK TO MARK

Mark observes as the bartender serves Jeff his drink. Jeff lifts his and nonchalantly asks Dee to cheer with him. She agrees without any reserve and, as they drink, Mark drinks with them. At the same time Jeff gestures to get one more for the lady. This is fascinating to Mark, he feels like he could never.

At that moment, Marks's attention is disrupted by RACHEL. She steps right in his line of sight on Jeff. She is dressed in a cute leather jacket, a large skirt and boots.

RACHEL

Hi.

He doesn't answer right away. Mark looks at her trying to conceal his uncertainty. He knows she's somewhat familiar, but can't really put his finger on it.

Throughout the following conversation Mark tries to sneakily look past Rachel on Jeff and Dee.

RACHEL (CONT'D)

Are you okay?

MARK

Yes. Yeah. Of course.

RACHEL

It's Rachel. You know me. I work at reception at the hospital.

MARK

Rachel, of course. How are you?

RACHEL

You had no idea, did you?

MARK

That's not - Well - I mean -

RACHEL

My God, Mark, calm down. I just wanted to check on you, you seemed kind of lost.

MARK

Lost?

RACHEL

Yeah. Lost. Staring blankly at an empty point in space.

She absorbs his undeniably confused stare and laughs.

RACHEL (CONT'D)

I was over there.

She points at a different booth with four other young women.

RACHEL (CONT'D)
And I noticed you glooming all
alone in this corner.

MARK
Did they notice as well?

RACHEL
What if I say yes? Are we all gonna
end up like the guy you came to see
this morning?

MARK
Sorry?

BACK ON JEFF AND DEE

They are sitting towards each other, in a happy mood. Both
their drinks running towards their end.

JEFF
I'm telling you.

DEE
There's no way.

JEFF
I swear to God. I can make it.

DEE
You can't.

JEFF
What if I can?

DEE
We'll see then. But you can't.

JEFF
As you wish, ma'am.

DEE
Don't call me ma'am, makes me feel
like I'm you are age.

JEFF
What's wrong with being my age?

She laughs.

Jeff checks that bartender is not looking and leans over the
counter to steal a couple of peanuts.

JEFF (CONT'D)
You ready?

DEE
Of course.

Jeff takes one of the peanuts and throws it towards the ceiling. As it heads down its parable, Jeff darts the other peanut hitting it perfectly. Both peanuts explode with debris falling on the counter.

Dee turns to Jeff, amazed.

DEE (CONT'D)
No fucking way.

JEFF
I told you.

DEE
That's crazy.

JEFF
So... What happens now that I made it?

She smugly shakes her head and turns back to the counter. He does the same.

DEE
You are stupid.

JEFF
(to bartender)
Can we get two more?

BACK TO MARK AND RACHEL

Rachel is now sitting in front of Mark. Every now and then Marks throws his eyes to Jeff and Dee on his right.

MARK
I have no idea what you are talking about.

RACHEL
Are you being for real right now?
I grew up here, Mark. I'm not stupid.

MARK

I'm really sorry, I think that maybe you had a little too much to drink. It's been a rough couple of weeks for everybody, maybe you should go home and get some sleep.

She laughs **loudly**. People turn to them.

Marks grabs her by the arm and brings her closer. She is not fazed at all.

MARK (CONT'D)

What the hell are you doing?

She takes her arm away from his grip and gently goes back to being composedly sat, confident smile still painted on her face.

RACHEL

I am doing the same thing you are doing, Mark. I'm enjoying a couple drink at my favorite bar. Right?

MARK

Right.

Dee's acute laugh is heard. Mark turns to her instinctively.

RACHEL

Why are you watching the sister now?

MARK

You really need to let it go.

RACHEL

I just want to help.

MARK

You don't even know what you are talking about.

RACHEL

And that's the beauty of it. I don't know and I don't need to know. I don't even want to know. I'll just keep an eye on things.

MARK

There are no things.

RACHEL

What about Rosenthal?

MARK

She's a medical professional and an old friend.

RACHEL

With a bit of a drinking problem.

MARK

I think you should leave now. You are talking nonsense.

RACHEL

You need me, Mark.

MARK

Leave. Go home. Get some sleep. I don't want to talk to you ever again. I think you should see a therapist, maybe. Probably.

She smiles.

RACHEL

Wow.

She stands up and, as she heads back to her table, Dee falls down from her chair.

Rachel turns to Mark and lifts her eyebrows.

BARTENDER

(to Jeff)

Come on. Get her out of here.

Jeff collects Dee and starts heading to the door with her arm over his shoulders.

Mark quickly stands up and runs behind them.

MARK

What are you doing?

JEFF

I'm taking her home, what do you think?

DEE

Hello stranger.

MARK

That's not the plan.

DEE

The plaaan.

JEFF
Shut your mouth, Mark.

The three of them reach the exit door.

EXT. THE GAS STATION - CONTINUOUS

Dee points at a yellow beat-up car parked close by.

DEE
That's my baby.

MARK
I'll drive her.

JEFF
Fuck off.

MARK
I'll follow.

Dee turns to Mark, dazed, then to Jeff.

DEE
Who's this guy, Frank? Is he a
friend of yours?

JEFF
Absolutely not.
(to Mark)
I'm not kidding, fuck off.

Dee and Jeff amble to her car as Mark stares at them. Wheels
in his brain spinning.

Jeff lays Dee over the backseat and takes his place behind
the wheel.

Mark rushes to the car as Jeff starts it. He knocks on the
window, but Jeff-

JEFF (CONT'D)
Fuck. Off.

Mark punches the window, energetically. Jeff stops the car
and rolls down the window.

MARK
What the fuck is this?

JEFF
What the fuck am I supposed to do,
leave her here?

MARK
Let me take her.

JEFF
People fucking saw us Mark. Have
you lost your damn mind? We can
pass it on, it's fine.

MARK
We can't pass it on.

DEE
Are you going to kill me, Frank?

JEFF
You need to let this go. Shit
happens. We got distracted.

MARK
We?

JEFF
Who's the brunette, eh Mark?

MARK
It's nobody.

JEFF
Yeah, sure.

DEE
Can we go, please? I'm not feeling
too well.

JEFF
Goodbye, Mark.

Jeff pulls up the window before reversing the car and
darting away from the parking lot.

Mark is left there, looking at it running away.

EXT. STREET - SAME TIME

Chris arrives with his bike at the end of a narrow street.
It leads into a path between trees.

He notices Tara's bike tied to the streetlamp at the end of
the street; Chris ties his to hers, before heading through
the path.

EXT. PATH - CONTINUOUS

Chris walks slowly. It's extremely dark, as the clouds don't even allow some moonlight to descend.

Owls chirp between the fronds, while Chris takes in the sound of each and every single one of his steps.

As he proceeds, he starts to hear some muffled sounds. The closer he gets, the more it starts to sound like a party.

He takes a few more steps, turning a corner, to reveal LEAH'S PARTY.

EXT. LEAH'S PARTY - CONTINUOUS

Leah has a house in the field. It is an old house of two stories, clearly an attempt to make it soundproof was made, yet the sounds still come out quite definite.

The front of the house is perfectly empty, but we can hear some clamor coming from the back.

Chris builds up his courage and walks towards the entrance.

He reaches the door and tries the handle. It's closed.

He knocks.

In a moment, a voice answers from inside.

JAMES (O.C.)
Hello?

CHRIS
James?

JAMES (O.C.)
Chris?

CHRIS
No shit.

James open the door.

JAMES
No way dude! You made it!

CHRIS
Of course I made it, man. Is Tara here already?

JAMES

Yeah she's somewhere around here.
But come in, quick.

Chris jumps in.

INT. ENTRANCE - LEAH'S HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

There's A LOT of people inside. Stroboscopic lights hang from the ceiling as people dance under them in the living room. Red cups and bottles are to be found everywhere.

CHRIS

Jesus Christ.

JAMES

Right?

CHRIS

Did Tara say anything about-

JAMES

Come on man, let's get you a drink.

James gestures to follow him. They wobble through the crowd to get to the kitchen.

INT. KITCHEN - LEAH'S HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

The kitchen is not as full, there's only a couple of girls and a guy (LEAH, TONI and DANNY) standing next to the fridge. There is a french door that leads to the backyard where more people are hanging out. There's basically no furniture, not even a table in the middle of the kitchen.

James leads the way in.

JAMES

Guess who's here guys?

Chris walks in behind him.

DANNY

Broo. Finally.

LEAH

Oh my God, Chrissy! It's so nice to see you!

Leah walks up to Chris and gives him a big hug which he awkwardly reciprocates.

LEAH (CONT'D)

Can I get you a beer or something?

CHRIS
Yeah sure, why not?

LEAH
That's the spirit.
(to Toni)
Can you get me a beer from the
fridge?

Toni kind of reluctantly takes a beer out and passes it to Leah, which passes it to Chris.

LEAH (CONT'D)
Actually, Ton', can you get me
another? I want to toast with this
guy.

Toni reopens the fridge, takes another beer and passes it to Leah.

Leah and Chris open their beers.

LEAH (CONT'D)
To an unforget-

She stops because she has noticed Danny and James are not holding a drink.

LEAH (CONT'D)
Come on guys, get yourself
something to drink.

TONI
Can I join as well?

Leah rolls her eyes in a way only Chris can see.

LEAH
Of course, Toni.

Toni, Danny and James collect some drinks here and there and now they are ready.

LEAH (CONT'D)
To an unforgettable night!

They all join glasses and as they do, Leah looks at Chris right in the eye.

EXT. BACKYARD - LEAH'S HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

Tara is in the backyard talking to a couple of friends of hers: CHELSEA (dark hair, short, stylish) and ROSE (red hair, tall, energetic).

TARA
It's such bullshit. I don't even care.

CHELSEA
You haven't talked about anything else since you got here.

ROSE
That's kind of true.

TARA
It's not like you could talk about anything other than James when you guys were dating, Rose.

CHELSEA
Are you guys dating?

TARA
No, Chelsea, we are not dating. Of course we are not dating.

ROSE
I don't get you guys.

TARA
Well, I don't either.

CHELSEA
Do you want a cigarette?

TARA
I really really do.

Chelsea takes a pack of cigarettes out of her purse and hands one to each of her friends.

They all take out their own lighter and lit it.

As they smoke, a HANDSOME GUY approaches from behind Tara.

He taps on her shoulder. Tara turns to him.

HANDSOME GUY
Hey, I'm sorry to bother, but I couldn't help but notice how beautiful you are tonight.

TARA
That's very nice of you.

HANDSOME GUY
I'm Joyner.

He extends his hand and she reciprocates.

TARA

Tara.

CHELSEA

You look very nice too.

ROSE

You do.

JOYNER

(to Tara)

Do I?

TARA

You do. You know you do.

JOYNER

Can I maybe get you a drink then?

She considers for a second, then-

TARA

I'm sorry, I'd rather not. Nothing against you, you seem like a very nice guy, it's just, no.

JOYNER

Is there a guy?

TARA

No.

CHELSEA

Yes.

TARA

No. I just don't want to.

HANDSOME GUY

Fair.

(a beat)

Have a nice evening ladies.

Joyner leaves.

ROSE

He called us ladies.

CHELSEA

He did.

TARA
Whatever.

ROSE
You really need to figure it out
with Chris.

TARA
Maybe you should go fuck that guy.

CHELSEA
HEY!

TARA
I'm sorry.

ROSE
Maybe I should.

The girls laugh as their cigarettes reach their orange
deaths. They throw them to the ground and step on them.
Chelsea pierces it with her stiletto.

CHELSEA
Sooo what now?

TARA
I'm kinda tired to be honest.

ROSE
Oh no no no no. You are not doing
this again. You always do this.

TARA
I'm a tired person.

CHELSEA
You are a boring person.

TARA
Why are you even wearing those
shoes?

Chelsea lifts her leg a little, pulls up her pants just
enough to reveal her dark, leathery right stiletto.

CHELSEA
Because they are the best thing
ever.

ROSE
How much were they?

CHELSEA
Not enough.

TARA
What do you mean?

CHELSEA
However much they were, they were a steal.

ROSE
So like - a shitload.

CHELSEA
Yeah.

Chelsea twirls her foot around a couple of times.

TARA
You can't even dance in them.

CHELSEA
That's honestly a crazy thing to say and I don't think I can be friends with a crazy person.

ROSE
She's right, tho.

CHELSEA
I biked here.

TARA
So what?

CHELSEA
Okay. We are going inside. I'll show you bitches.

ROSE
Do you need some help walking back in?

CHELSEA
Ah ah ah. Very funny Rose. Fuck you. Let's go.

The three girls head inside with Rose and Tara leading and Chelsea following one small step at a time, yet not falling.

They reach the french door and enter.

INT. KITCHEN - LEAH'S HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

Chris and the others are enjoying themselves in the kitchen when the girls come in. Tara notices Leah's hand holding onto Chris' arm, but doesn't give it any reaction.

TARA
Hey guys.

DANNY
Hi.

ROSE
Hi James.

JAMES
Hi Rose.

The girls head for the living room to dance. Chris slips out of Leah's hand to stop Tara. He grabs as she reaches the kitchen's door.

Chelsea and Rose see them and disappear in the crowd.

CHRIS
Hey.

TARA
What's up?

CHRIS
Are you okay?

TARA
Yeah why?

CHRIS
I don't like the way we left each other there.

TARA
I don't like it either, but you are an asshole, so what can you do?

CHRIS
Come on, Tara. Can we talk about it?

TARA
Listen Chris, there's nothing to talk about. It's nothing. Go enjoy your night.

A guy walks by with a tray full of shots, Tara grabs one.

TARA (CONT'D)
I'm gonna have this shot, I'm gonna
dance with the girls, and I'll see
you tomorrow, okay?

CHRIS
I'm really sorry Tara.

Tara takes the shot.

TARA
See you around okay?

Tara heads in the crowd.

INT. LIVING ROOM - LEAH'S HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

MONTAGE OF TARA, CHELSEA AND ROSE HAVING FUN, DANCING,
TAKING SHOTS.

As the montage ends...

TARA
I'm gonna go the bathroom.

ROSE
WHAT?!

TARA
I said: I'M GONNA GO THE BATHROOM!!

She says it very loudly, people around hear her very
clearly. Chelsea and Rose give her thumbs up before going
back to dancing.

Tara heads for the entrance where the stairs to the second
floor are.

INT. STAIRS/UPSTAIRS - LEAH'S HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

Tara stumbles a bit on those squeaky, wooden stairs, but
eventually reaches the second floor.

There, only a small, dying, hanging light bulb illuminates
the place.

There are four doors and she has no idea where the bathroom
is.

She tries the first, but it's closed. Same goes for the
second one.

Tara then goes for the third one. She hears voices inside. Sounds like two people. Maybe it's nothing, maybe she knows better, maybe she doesn't. She opens the door to find...

CHRIS AND LEAH KISSING ON A BED.

Tara SLAMS the door before either of them can say anything. With tears in her eyes she bolts down the stairs.

INT. UPSTAIRS - LEAH'S HOUSE - MOMENTS LATER

Chris comes out of the room, Leah is behind him looking perplexed.

Chris hurries to the stairs.

INT. STAIRS/ENTRANCE - LEAH'S HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

As he walks down the stairs, Chris sees the door opened with Chelsea and Rose by it.

CHELSEA

Tara!

ROSE

T! Come on!

Chris rushes to them.

CHRIS

Tara. What's happening.

ROSE

Oh. Here he is.

TARA

What the fuck did you do?

CHRIS

I didn't- I didn't do anything-
what the fuck?

Rose peeks behind him to see Leah is on top of the stairs, observing.

Rose signals Leah's presence to Chelsea. Chelsea slaps Chris' arm.

CHELSEA

What the fuck, Chris?

ROSE

You are a piece of shit, you know?

CHRIS

Listen. I'm gonna go after her,
okay?

CHELSEA, ROSE

NOOO!!!

EXT. FIELDS - MOMENTS LATER

Tara is running, while bawling her eyes out. The sound of the party disappears in the distance as she runs away.

After a while, she stops.

The party is now faraway and she's all alone. There's not a single sound. Not a living soul. Just some owls hooting in the fronds.

She looks around trying to figure out where she got, but she has no idea.

She sniffles and dries her eyes, then decides to head back towards the party.

She takes a left quite soon, too soon, and after a few steps realizes it's not the way she came from. She goes back on the main path again. She is turned around and sad and confused and maybe a bit drunk, but she just starts to cry again.

She sits down, with her back on a large tree, and puts her head between her knees.

She cries and cries.

TARA

Stupid. You are so fucking stupid.

Suddenly, she hears STEPS coming from the direction opposed to the one she came from.

She freezes, terrified. The steps come closer and closer.

Until THE MAN IN THE FEDORA HAT APPEARS, STILL HOLDING THE BRIEFCASE HE GOT IN THE COLD OPEN.

Tara barely has the time to take in the suit and the hat, before instinctively jumping behind the three to hide.

She holds her breath as tear drip down her cheeks.

TARA'S POV: The Man in The Fedora steps in front of Tara's tree, maybe he slows down while he passes it, maybe he doesn't, but it feels to Tara like it takes him ages. Finally the man proceeds and takes a left soon after.

EXT. FIELDS - MOMENTS LATER

Chris is walking away from the party, knowing full well Tara either can't leave without him or as left on foot and he can catch up to her.

As he approaches the path he came from, he sees Tara running in his direction.

CHRIS

Tara?

He looks at her and, although it's dark, can tell there's something wrong with her.

He picks up and heads towards her, running.

The moment they are close enough, Tara throws herself between his arms. He hugs her as tight as he can, while she cries on his chest.

CHRIS (CONT'D)

Are you okay, T? I-

TARA

He was right. He wasn't making it up. He was telling the truth.

CHRIS

What?

TARA

Josh.

CHRIS

No he wasn't.

Tara pulls back from his chest and looks up at him.

TARA

I saw one of them. He had the suit, the hat, everything he said.

Chris eyes widen.

CHRIS

No you didn't.

TARA

What?

CHRIS

Josh wasn't well, Tara. You didn't see anything.

TARA

But-

CHRIS

No. You didn't see anything.

Tara swallows and nods, before putting her head back on his chest.

TARA

They killed him.

CHRIS

No one killed anybody. No one.

INT. MARK'S CAR - NIGHT

Mark is driving frantically. On the passenger seat is a closed thin folder titled: DEANDRA (DEE) HAWTORNE.

He takes a hard left before parking soon after.

Mark opens the glove compartment. It's messy inside. He starts pulling stuff out of it. Gloves, black beanie, papers of all colors and dimensions, finally he finds a little silk bag, from which he extracts a small vial containing a white liquid. He puts the vial in his jacket pocket, puts on the beanie and the gloves and heads out.

EXT. DEE'S BUILDING - CONTINUOUS

Mark's car is parked right in front of Dee's decaying apartment building. It's a grey three stories building where the front door it's never closed. Mark walks right in.

INT. DEE'S BUILDING - CONTINUOUS

Mark enters and heads right for the stairs. He walks fast and silently. Some background noises emerge from the various apartments.

As he reaches the second floor the automatic lights go on.

He sprints towards apartment 202, Dee's.

Paranoid, he keeps looking around while he tries to break into the apartment using a paperclip.

The lock gives up and he disappears inside.

INT. DEE'S APARTMENT - CONTINUOUS

Dee's apartment is small, a little claustrophobic even. Mark walks through the narrow entrance corridor lead only by the tenuous light coming from ahead of him.

Mark follows the light until he reaches the living room, where there she is. Dee is passed out on the couch, with half a glass of water and a cute night lamp next to her.

He grabs a pillow from an armchair and heads towards her, and as he does, his shadow slowly begins to cover her body.

Mark leans onto her and is ready to suffocate her, when...

MIAO.

Mark turns around to find a kitten looking at him. The kitten takes a couple of steps towards Mark and scratches his head onto his shin. When the kitten realizes Mark is not going to pet him, it decides to jump onto Dee's legs.

The kitten takes his place between Dee's legs forming a little loaf, all while keeping his eyes on Mark.

Mark, stunned, drops the pillow to the floor. He picks the little vial out of his pocket and drops his content in the glass of water. Then he looks at the cat, then at Dee, who's just there, sleeping with her mouth opened, unaware of everything.

Mark picks up the glass and pours the water on the carpeted floor. He puts down the glass where it was and heads out.

As Mark exits we see the kitten jumping off the couch and sniffing the wet area of the carpet...

INT. MARK'S APARTMENT - A LITTLE LATER

Coincidentally, Mark's apartment looks exactly like Dee's, just symmetrically opposite and way messier. There's a landline phone on the table in the living room and a square TV in front of the couch.

There are cartons and bottles everywhere, the walls are moldy and the carpet is full of stains.

We, from the couch perspective, watch the door open and Mark coming inside.

He leaves his shoes right next to the door, where he takes off his shirt, belt and watch.

He heads for the living room, where he throws everything on the ground, before continuing towards the phone which starts RINGING the moments he has reached it.

He picks up immediately.

MARK

Yeah?

Muffled sounds come from the other side of the receiver.

MARK (CONT'D)

No.

The muffled sounds get agitated.

MARK (CONT'D)

We are gonna pass it on. Goodnight.

Mark puts down the receiver and ambles to sit right next to us on the couch.

He picks up the remote next to him and turns on the TV.

The screen turns white and CAMERA PANS INTO IT UNTIL...

ON OUR SCREEN WE SEE WHAT MARK SEES ON HIS TV.

It's black and white, but at the start it's just white all around.

A VAUDEVILLIAN jumps in the frame, from the right, for the enthusiasm of the exulting audience.

Soft music starts playing and the vaudevillian jumps and twirls and spins before his greatest trick where he throws his top hat to the sky and makes it fall right on his head.

The vaudevillian bows to the audience, but surprisingly they don't cheer. The music cuts. He looks up confused and says something looking straight into camera.

The title card where his words would be appears, but there's nothing written on it.

The vaudevillian stunned looks around that white void, which leads a thunderous laughter to fill it, but the laughter it's not with him, it's anonymous and mean. He shakes his head and the laughter stops.

He starts performing again, only this time there's no music accompanying. He tries to go, but we can see it on his face that he is worried.

When it comes to the grand finale with the hat, he just can't bring himself to do it.

The vaudevillian drops his hat to the ground and walks right in front of the camera. He puts his face right in the scope and looks straight at the audience. He is terrified.

He says something, but again, the title card appears with nothing written on it.

The man looks left, then right, then left again, before coming back to the audience. His eyes widen in the throes of a vivid folly and... HE SCREAMS ON TOP OF HIS LUNGS, IN SILENCE...

FADE TO BLACK.

A soft melody starts to play.

THE WRITING "SCREAMING IN A SILENT PICTURE" APPEARS, BEFORE LEAVING SPACE TO:

THE END.

END OF PILOT.